LITERATURE ESSAY GUIDELINES

STEP-BY-STEP FORMULA FOR AN INTRODUCTION

- Name the text and author - always start by mentioning the title of the text (underlined) and the author.
- Show you understand the topic -restate the essay question or theme in your own words.
- Mention 2–3 key points you will discuss - briefly point to the moments, characters, or ideas you will analyse in your essay.
- Give a clear thesis (your main argument) - make a direct statement about how you plan to unpack this topic.

FORMULA IN PRACTICE

In [text] by [author], [theme/character/idea] is important because [short explanation]. This is shown through [point 1], [point 2], and [point 3]. Together, these moments reveal [your thesis/argument].

MAKE SURE YOUR INTRODUCTION DOES THREE THINGS:

- ✓ Tells the reader what text you're writing about,
- ✓ Shows you understand the question/theme,
- ✓ Makes it clear what your argument will be (your stance).

HOW TO WRITE LITERATURE ESSAY CONCLUSION

GUIDELINES

1. **Restate the main idea / thesis**
   Remind the reader of your overall argument, but use different words than in the introduction.
2. **Summarise key points**
   Briefly mention the main ideas from your body paragraphs without going into detail.
3. **Show the broader significance**
   Explain why this matters. So what? How does it deepen understanding of the character, theme or text as a whole?
4. **End with a strong closing sentence**
   Leave the reader with something memorable — a final insight, reflection or universal idea.

LITERATURE ESSAY CONCLUSION TEMPLATE

1. **Restate thesis in new words:**
   "Overall, [main character/idea] demonstrates that [central argument about theme or character]."
2. **Summarise key points:**
   "Through [point 1], [point 2], and [point 3], [character/author] shows [how theme is explored or idea is developed]."
3. **Show broader significance / insight:**
   "This reveals that [what the reader should understand about life, human nature, society, or the text]."
4. **End with a strong final sentence:**
   "Ultimately, [character/idea] ~~proves~~ suggests/indicates/confirms that [lasting message or universal truth]."

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